

company is advancing sustainable polyester technologies.

Fashion brand Trent, which owns popular retail chains Zudio and Westside, is also embracing sustainability, concentrating on product life cycle, materials and customer safety.

It has collaborated with waste management company WiseBin for plastic waste recycling.

Another leading fashion retail company, Aditya Birla Fashion and Retail (ABFRL), is advancing its decade-old 'ReEarth Vision' into Sustainability 2.0 by adopting sustainable sourcing and production practices to enhance circularity and improve the product lifecycle.

WITH TECH'S HELP

The evolving technological landscape is helping companies in their initiatives. ABFRL is using artificial intelligence (AI) to enhance innovation and integrate greener processes.

Sharmila Senthilraja, Vice President and Industry Platform Leader for Consumer Products and Retail – India, Capgemini says, "AI is streamlining inventory management, reducing over-production, and enabling more responsible sourcing decisions. Blockchain ensures transparency and traceability throughout the supply chain."

Start-ups and MSMEs are not behind. Gurugram-based clothing manufacturer and supplier ZYOD is harnessing AI to forecast trends and streamline on-demand production. "This tech-driven approach ensures faster turnaround and reduced waste. Our adaptable MOQ (Minimum Order Quality) lets brands produce exactly what they need, cutting waste and supporting a data-driven path to scale," says co-founder Ankit Jaipuria.

WASTE TO WERABLES

Some emerging brands are also trying to bring in tangible change. Hyderabad-based Nicobar uses fabrics like certified 100% organic cotton, recycled polyes-



"Demand for cheap, trendy clothing drives high volume, low-margin manufacturing that undermines environmental and social sustainability"

SAYOOJ THEKKEVARIATH
PARTNER, CLIMATE CHANGE AND
SUSTAINABILITY SERVICES, EY INDIA



"Our adaptable Minimum Order Quality lets brands produce exactly what they need, cutting waste and supporting a data-driven path to scale"

ANKIT JAIPURIA
CO-FOUNDER, ZYOD

ter, TENCEL (fabric made from regenerated cellulose fibres), biodegradable Bemberg, and bamboo fabric instead of polyester. Similarly, New Delhi-based Doodlage is turning plastic bottles to fusion wear.

FASHION WITH CONSCIENCE

Sustainability shouldn't be limited to a buzzword anymore. It should be a way of life. But are Indian shoppers ready to ditch fast fashion?

According to a 2023 Bain & Company report, over 65% of urban consumers say they're concerned about climate change, but only 13% actively factor sustainability into fashion purchases.

Thekkevariath says strategies such as storytelling through QR-coded labels showing environmental impact can be leveraged to increase awareness. Globally, countries like Sweden and France are already nudging both brands and buyers toward circular fashion. Meanwhile, the EU's Green Deal mandates that by 2025, all EU member states must establish separate textile waste collection systems.

Closer home, Bangladesh and Vietnam have embraced sustainability through factory-level certifications like LEED (Leadership in Energy and Environmental Design) and Higg Index. Bangladesh's Green Garment Factories movement, backed by global buyers, now boasts over 200 LEED-certified units.

As India steps up decarbonisation, its textile industry has the potential to lead the way. But it would require more than just talk to achieve this. **BT**

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